SportingSpy

WEBSITE OWNER'S GUIDE

Running SportingSpy: day to day, looking great, and growing revenue

Where to find everything in the admin panel, how to publish and present content well, and the practical steps that turn traffic into income.

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For the site owner and editorial team. No technical knowledge needed. Button and menu names are written **like this** exactly as they appear on screen.

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The three addresses you need

- **Public website:** your site's address (for example `https://www.sportingspy.com/` once the final domain is connected).
- **Admin panel (CMS):** the same address followed by `/admin/`
- **Your own profile and security:** the same address followed by `/account/`

Until the final domain is switched over, the site runs on its temporary staging address. Everything in this guide works the same on both.

CHAPTER 1

Quick map: where to go for what

Everything is managed from the admin panel at `/admin/`. The left-hand menu lists every area. Some areas only appear for Admins.

I want to…	Go to
Write or edit an article	**Articles** → **New** (or open an existing one)
Review articles submitted by Authors	**Dashboard** → *articles awaiting editorial review*, or **Articles** review queue
Add a sport, tournament (event) or a year's edition	**Sports**, **Events & Editions**
Upload or manage images	**Media Library**
Change the homepage, menu, footer or announcement bar	**Site Experience**
Edit About, Contact, Privacy, Terms or DMCA, or add a new page	**Pages**
Add questions and answers to a page	**FAQ**
Read messages sent through the contact form	**Contact Inbox**
Set up ads and sponsor banners	**Ad Placements** and **Settings** → *Analytics & advertising*
See which content gets the most views	**Analytics & Insights**
Check the site's SEO health	**SEO Intelligence** → **Run scan now**
Send an old address to a new one	**URL Redirects (301/302)**
Add a writer or change someone's role	**User Roles & RBAC** and **Authors / Beats**
See who changed what, and when	**Audit Logs**
Site name, Google/Bing connections, AdSense, privacy options	**Settings** (Admin only)
Change my password, photo or two-factor sign-in	**My account** (top right of the admin panel)

> **Tip: the Dashboard is your home screen**
>
> It shows counts of sports, events, articles and staff, articles waiting for review, quick buttons (`+ New Editorial Article` , `+ Create Event / Edition` , `+ Add Author` , `+ URL Redirect`) and the latest activity.

CHAPTER 2

Signing in and keeping accounts safe

Who can do what

Role	Can do	Give this role to
Admin	Everything: users, settings, deleting sports/events/pages, redirects, site migration.	The owner and at most one trusted deputy.
Editor	Write, review and publish articles; manage events, editions, FAQ, Pages (not delete), Site Experience, insights.	Senior staff who decide what goes live.
Author	Write their own drafts and submit them for review. Cannot publish.	Writers and contributors.

Adding a new writer

1. Open `User Roles & RBAC` and create the account with the person's email and the **Author** role.
2. Open `Authors / Beats` and create (or link) their public author profile: byline name, short bio, photo.
3. Send them the sign-in address `/admin/`. They should change their password at once in `My account`.

Protect your account

- **Turn on two-factor sign-in:** `My account` → `Security`. It uses a phone authenticator app. Do this for every Admin and Editor.
- **Forgotten password:** use *Forgot your password?* on the sign-in screen, or an Admin issues a reset link from `User Roles & RBAC`.
- **Lost phone:** an Admin can reset two-factor sign-in for that user.
- **Someone leaves:** deactivate their account the same day. Their published articles stay online.
- **Profile photo:** `My account` → `Upload from device`, then `Save profile`.

> **Never share passwords**
>
> Each person gets their own account. Shared logins make the `Audit Logs` useless and cannot be switched off for one person.

CHAPTER 3

How the site is organised

SportingSpy is built like a well-run sports archive. Every piece of content sits in a fixed hierarchy, and the web addresses follow it automatically:

Level	What it is	Example address
Sport	A discipline, with its own hub page.	`/tennis/`
Event	A permanent competition that returns every year.	`/tennis/french-open/`
Edition	One year of that event, with its dates, venue and details.	`/tennis/french-open/2027/`
Article	A story, guide or analysis, attached to a sport, event or edition.	`/tennis/french-open/2027/how-to-watch/`

Why this matters for you

- **Create the structure first.** Before writing about the 2027 French Open, make sure the Sport, the Event and the 2027 Edition exist. The article then appears in all the right places automatically.
- **Events are evergreen.** The event page collects every year's coverage. Search engines love these long-lived pages, so keep them complete and accurate.
- **Edition descriptions:** aim for 80–150 words: dates, venue, format and what makes this year notable.
- **Hidden items:** a sport or event can be hidden while you prepare it. Hidden items are not shown to visitors or search engines.

> **Changing a name or address is safe**
>
> If you change the slug (the address part) of a sport, event or article, the system automatically redirects the old address to the new one, so links and Google rankings are kept. Still, avoid changing addresses without a good reason.

CHAPTER 4

Publishing articles

The publishing routine

1. `Articles` → `New`. Choose the **Sport**, then the **Event** and **Edition** if the article is about one, then the **Article Type** (news, guide, how to watch, analysis…).
2. Write a clear, specific title and a short excerpt (the summary shown on cards and in search results).
3. Write the body. Use headings (H2, H3) to break it into sections. Add tables, quotes, image galleries and related-story cards from the toolbar and `Add block`.
4. Choose a **featured image** from the Media Library. Every article should have one.
5. Click `Check SEO` and fix anything it flags.
6. **Preview** the article exactly as visitors will see it.
7. **Publish** now, or **schedule** a date and time. Scheduled articles go live automatically.

When Authors submit work

Authors cannot publish. Their drafts arrive in the review queue (shown on the Dashboard). An Admin or Editor opens the draft, then either approves and publishes it, or requests changes with a comment. Nothing an Author writes goes live without a human decision.

Quality rules that keep readers and Google happy

Be accurate

Check schedules, results, prize money and broadcaster details against the official source before publishing. Update articles when details change.

Be useful

Answer the reader's real question in the first paragraphs: when, where, how to watch, who is playing.

Link inside the site

Link to the event page, edition page and related guides. Readers stay longer and search engines understand the site better.

Use AI carefully

AI suggestions are only starting points. A person must check every fact before it is published.

CHAPTER 5

Images and the Media Library

All images live in the `Media Library`. Upload once, then reuse anywhere: articles, sports, events, pages and social sharing.

- **Formats:** JPEG, PNG, WebP or AVIF, up to 10 MB. The system automatically creates fast, mobile-friendly versions.
- **Always fill in:** title, **alt text** (a short description for blind readers and Google), credit and source.
- **Copyright:** record where each image came from (SportingSpy original, licensed, official source, Creative Commons, AI-created…) and its licence. Mark doubtful images as *restricted*; restricted images cannot be used.
- **Duplicates:** if you upload an image that already exists, the system tells you and offers the existing one.
- **Deleting:** an image that is in use cannot be deleted. Remove it from that content first.

> **Only publish images you have the right to use**
> Copying photos from other websites or social media can lead to takedown notices and legal claims, and can get an AdSense account suspended. Use licensed images, official press images that allow editorial use, or your own.

Making images look professional

- Use landscape images for featured images (roughly 16:9), at least 1200 pixels wide.
- Keep the same visual style across a sport: similar framing, no heavy text on images.
- Choose a strong default social image in `Settings` → *SEO & social defaults*. It is used when a shared page has no image of its own.

CHAPTER 6

Making the site look great

The look and layout of the public site is controlled from `Site Experience`. It has five areas:

Area	What you control
Homepage	The intro (hero) section with its image and text, and which sections and featured content appear, in what order.
Navigation	The main menu at the top of every page.
Footer	Tagline, link columns, social media links and copyright line.
Announcements	A bar across the top for breaking news or notices, with optional start and end times.
Blocks	Extra content blocks used around the site.

The safe way to change the design

1. Make your changes and click `Save draft`. Visitors see nothing yet.
2. Use `Preview saved drafts` to browse the real site with your changes, visible only to you.
3. When happy, `Preview / Publish` to make it live, or **schedule** it (for example, a tournament takeover that starts on day one).
4. Changed your mind? `Discard saved draft` returns to what is live.

Design tips

- **Lead with what is happening now.** Feature the current or next big event on the homepage and change it as the sports calendar moves.
- **Keep the menu short:** 5–7 items. Put everything else in the footer.
- **Use announcements sparingly**, only for genuinely important news, and always set an end time.
- **Check on a phone.** Most visitors read on mobile. Preview every design change on a phone before publishing.
- **Light and dark mode** are built in. Check both after changing colours or images.
- Set the site name and description once in `Settings` → *Site identity*.

CHAPTER 7

Pages: About, legal and custom pages

The `Pages` area holds the site's informational pages. Five are marked **Required**: About, Contact, Privacy Policy, Terms of Service and DMCA. You can edit their text at any time, but their addresses are fixed and they always stay published.

Create a new page (for example an Editorial Policy)

1. `Pages` → `New page`. Type the title; the address (slug) fills in automatically, for example `/editorial-policy/`.
2. Write the content with the same editor used for articles. Add a subtitle if useful (for example *Last revised: October 2026*).
3. In *Search & social*, write an SEO title (under 70 characters) and SEO description (under 160), and pick a social image.
4. `Save draft`, then `Preview` to check it privately.
5. `Publish`. The page is now public and included in the sitemap.

Show the page in the footer

`Site Experience` → **Footer** → on a link row, choose the page in the **Page** list. The address and label fill in for you. Save and publish the footer.

> **Good to know**
>
> - Saving a published page updates the live page immediately.
> - `Unpublish` takes a page offline (its address shows "page not found").
> - A page linked from the live footer or menu cannot be unpublished or deleted until the link is removed, so visitors never hit a broken link.
> - The Privacy Policy's cookie table and analytics/advertising sections are written automatically from your settings and stay correct when you switch services on or off. The contact form appears automatically on the Contact page.

Pages worth adding

Editorial Policy, Corrections Policy, Advertise With Us, and a page about how you verify information. These build trust with readers and advertisers, and Google's quality guidelines favour sites that explain who is behind them.

CHAPTER 8

Getting found on Google (SEO)

Most of the technical SEO is already built in: clean addresses, sitemaps, page titles, social previews, structured data and automatic redirects. Your job is to publish great content and connect the search engines.

One-time setup (Admin, in Settings)

1. **Google Search Console:** add your site in Search Console, paste the verification token into `Settings` → *Search engine verification*, then submit your sitemap: `/sitemap.xml`.
2. **Bing Webmaster Tools:** the same steps, with the Bing verification token. Bing also powers several AI assistants and search tools.
3. **IndexNow:** set a key in `Settings` → *IndexNow* so Bing and others learn about new articles within minutes.
4. **Search engine data:** once connected, your developer can link Search Console and Bing so their data appears in `Analytics & Insights`.

Every week

- Open `SEO Intelligence` → `Run scan now`. Fix **Blocking** issues first, then **Warnings**.
- Check *Excluded URLs and why*. Pages left out of the sitemap are usually thin (too little content) or hidden on purpose.
- Review *Redirect & link health* for broken links.

What actually moves rankings

Publish before the event

"How to watch", schedules and previews should be live 1–3 weeks before a tournament, when people start searching.

Own your event pages

Keep each event and edition page complete: dates, venue, format, broadcasters, history, records.

Answer questions

Use `FAQ` on articles, editions and events. Turn on FAQ structured data so answers can appear in Google results.

Update, don't duplicate

Refresh last year's guide into this year's edition instead of writing near-identical new pages.

> **Changing addresses**
>
> The system adds redirects automatically when addresses change. If you ever move content by hand, add a redirect in `URL Redirects (301/302)` so old links keep working.

CHAPTER 9

Making money from the site

Revenue grows with **trust** and **traffic**. The site supports two income streams today: **display advertising** through Google AdSense, and **direct sponsorship** banners that you sell yourself.

Stream 1: Google AdSense

1. Apply for AdSense with your final domain once you have a solid base of original, useful articles and the Required pages (About, Contact, Privacy) are complete. Thin or copied content is the most common reason for rejection.
2. After approval, an Admin enters the **AdSense publisher ID** in `Settings` → *Analytics & advertising*. Optionally turn on **AdSense Auto ads**.
3. In `Ad Placements`, choose **Google AdSense** for the slots you want and paste each ad unit ID from your AdSense account.
4. Ads appear only to visitors who allow advertising in their privacy choices. This is required by privacy law and by Google; the consent banner handles it automatically.

Stream 2: Direct sponsorship (often worth more)

In `Ad Placements`, choose **House / sponsor** for a slot and upload the partner's banner. It is shown with a *Sponsored* label, loads fast and needs no third-party code. Typical buyers: sports equipment shops, sports bars, fan travel agencies, ticket sellers, local clubs and streaming services.

- Sell placements by event ("French Open takeover, 2 weeks") or by sport section.
- Use `Analytics & Insights` to show sponsors real page-view numbers for the section they are buying.
- Create an **Advertise With Us** page (see Chapter 7) with your audience figures and a contact address.

Growth habits that raise income

Habit	Why it pays
Follow the sports calendar	Big tournaments bring traffic spikes. Plan content 4–6 weeks ahead for each major event.
Grow what already works	Each month, find your top articles in Insights and write related guides that link to them.
Keep evergreen pages fresh	Updated event pages keep ranking year after year: steady, compounding traffic.
Share on social media	Add your social profiles in the footer and share each new guide. Good social images (Chapter 5) increase clicks.
Don't overload pages with ads	Too many ads slow pages and drive readers away. Fewer, well-placed slots usually earn more over time.

> **Protect your AdSense account**
>
> Never click your own ads or ask others to. Never publish copied text or unlicensed images. Keep the Privacy Policy and consent banner switched on. Breaking these rules can close the account permanently.

Income depends on traffic, audience location and season. No setting guarantees revenue; consistent, high-quality content does the work.

CHAPTER 10

Measuring what works

`Analytics & Insights` (Admin and Editor) shows how the site is doing, for today, 7 days, 28 days, 3/6/12 months or a custom period, compared with the period before.

Section	Use it to
Overview	See page views, article views, event and edition views and site searches, and whether they are rising.
Content performance	Find your top articles and events, and which sports and article types attract readers.
Site search	See what readers search for, and especially searches with **no results**. Those are your next articles.
Core Web Vitals	Check page speed on mobile and desktop. Alerts appear if pages get slower.
Search engines	Google and Bing clicks and positions, once connected (Chapter 8).
Publishing activity	Track how much the team publishes each week.

For deeper analysis (visitors, traffic sources, devices), add a **GA4 measurement ID** in `Settings` → *Analytics & advertising*. Google Analytics only runs for visitors who allow it.

> **A simple monthly review**
>
> Which 10 pages got the most views? Which searches found nothing? Which events are coming next month? Turn the answers into next month's content plan.

CHAPTER 11

Routine checklists

Every day

- [ ] Review and publish submitted drafts
- [ ] Answer messages in `Contact Inbox`
- [ ] Update live event details (results, schedule changes)
- [ ] Check the homepage features the right event

Every week

- [ ] Run `SEO Intelligence` scan and fix blocking issues
- [ ] Plan content for events 2–6 weeks away
- [ ] Add FAQs to the most-read pages
- [ ] Share new guides on social media

Every month

- [ ] Monthly review in `Analytics & Insights`
- [ ] Refresh top evergreen articles and event pages
- [ ] Check sponsor slots and renewals in `Ad Placements`
- [ ] Skim `Audit Logs` for unexpected changes
- [ ] Remove accounts of people who have left

Before each major tournament

- [ ] Edition created with dates, venue and format
- [ ] How-to-watch, schedule and preview articles live
- [ ] Homepage and announcement scheduled in `Site Experience`
- [ ] Sponsor placement sold and scheduled
- [ ] FAQs added to the edition page

CHAPTER 12

Rules that protect the site

Do	Don't
Give each person their own account and the lowest role they need.	Share the Admin login or give everyone Admin.
Turn on two-factor sign-in for Admins and Editors.	Reuse passwords from other websites.
Use `Save draft` and preview before publishing design changes.	Publish large design changes during a big event without previewing.
Record the source and licence of every image.	Copy images or text from other websites.
Check AI-suggested content against official sources.	Publish AI text without a human check.
Keep the Required pages accurate and up to date.	Remove legal pages or the privacy choices link from the footer.
Use `Unpublish` to take content offline temporarily.	Delete content that has earned links and traffic; update it instead.

Every change is recorded

`Audit Logs` lists who changed what and when, with before-and-after values. If something looks wrong on the site, start there.

CHAPTER 13

What to ask your developer

Everything in this guide can be done from the admin panel. These tasks are technical and should be handled by your developer:

Task	Why it needs a developer
Connecting the final domain `www.sportingspy.com`	Involves DNS, security certificates and the switch from the old site, with redirects for old addresses.
Hosting, database and image storage	The site runs on managed cloud services (web hosting, a PostgreSQL database and image storage). Plans, limits and backups are managed there.
Backups and restores	Ask for a backup before any major change and confirm backups are taken regularly.
Search Console / Bing data connection	Requires secure credentials on the server.
New features or design changes beyond Site Experience	Require code changes and testing.
The site is down or very slow	Check hosting status and logs.

> **Keep secrets secret**
> Never send passwords, database addresses, API keys or AdSense account access by email or chat. If you think a password has leaked, change it immediately and tell your developer.

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